

Task 6: Recruitment Problems Faced by Ayurveda-Focused MSMEs

Ayurveda-student focused research report for project/team discussion | India

1. Research Scope

This report focuses specifically on the recruitment challenges faced by MSMEs and small organisations working in the Ayurveda ecosystem when they recruit Ayurveda students, interns, fresh graduates and early-career professionals. Relevant areas include Ayurveda clinics, wellness centres, Ayurveda hospitals, product/manufacturing businesses, research organisations, education and related services.

NCISM's current framework for undergraduate Ayurveda education includes formal curriculum, clinical training and internship-oriented components. NCISM also states that Ayurveda medical education should prepare high-quality professionals, encourage research and adapt to changing needs. These requirements make practical employability and role-specific skill matching important recruitment considerations. ■cite■turn0search36■turn0search0■

2. Major Recruitment Problems for Ayurveda Students

1. Ayurveda-Specific Skill–Job Mismatch

The strongest problem is the gap between what an Ayurveda MSME needs for a particular role and what a student can demonstrate. A student may have academic knowledge but the employer may need a combination of clinical practice, documentation, communication, patient interaction, research, product knowledge or business-related skills.

2. Difficulty Assessing Practical Readiness

Marks, degrees and certificates do not always show how confidently a student can perform practical tasks. Employers may need to evaluate clinical reasoning, patient communication, case documentation, basic procedures, counselling or role-specific practical ability.

3. Limited Industry Exposure

Students can have strong classroom knowledge but limited exposure to how smaller Ayurveda organisations actually operate. For product-oriented MSMEs, additional understanding of manufacturing workflows, quality processes, documentation, customer communication or market-facing work may be useful.

4. Communication and Patient-Handling Skills

Ayurveda clinics and wellness organisations need employees who can communicate clearly with patients or customers, explain procedures appropriately, listen carefully and maintain professional behaviour. These skills can be difficult to infer from a resume.

5. Role Diversity Across the Ayurveda Ecosystem

An Ayurveda student may encounter very different roles: clinical support, consultation-related work where legally and professionally appropriate, research assistance, quality/documentation, Ayurveda product support, wellness services, content/education and operations. A generic resume does not always communicate which roles and skills the candidate fits.

6. Experience and Internship Gap

Employers may prefer candidates who have already handled practical responsibilities. Fresh students or graduates may therefore find it difficult to compete with candidates who have relevant internship or field exposure.

7. Limited Recruitment Resources in Small Organisations

Many small Ayurveda businesses have limited HR capacity. Recruitment may be handled by owners or managers, making structured job descriptions, candidate screening and skill assessments difficult.

8. Salary and Career-Path Constraints

A small organisation may have limited ability to compete with larger hospitals, established healthcare organisations or other employers on compensation, benefits and clearly defined career progression.

9. Location and Talent-Availability Mismatch

Some Ayurveda MSMEs operate in smaller cities or locations where the pool of candidates with the desired combination of Ayurveda knowledge and practical/industry skills can be limited.

10. Retention After Training

An organisation may invest time in training a new Ayurveda employee and later lose that employee to another opportunity. This creates repeated recruitment and onboarding effort.

3. What Is the Biggest Problem?

Ayurveda Skill–Job Matching and Practical Skill Verification is the most useful problem to focus on for this project. The challenge is not simply that there are too few Ayurveda students. The deeper issue is that an MSME needs to know whether a particular student has the specific combination of skills required for its role.

Student side: “I have Ayurveda knowledge, but I am not sure which additional skills the employer expects.”

MSME side: “I have a vacancy, but I need a quick and reliable way to identify students who actually fit this role.”

4. Ayurveda Student Skill Framework

Skill Category	Examples
Core Ayurveda knowledge	Ayurveda Samhita & Siddhanta, Dravyaguna, Roganidana, Kayachikitsa and other curriculum areas
Clinical/practical exposure	Case documentation, clinical observation, patient interaction, supervised practical work
Communication	Patient communication, counselling, professional interaction, teamwork
Research & evidence skills	Research methodology, basic data handling, literature search and scientific communication
Industry/product skills	Documentation, quality awareness, product knowledge and role-specific processes
Digital skills	Basic computer skills, digital documentation, online research and relevant software/tools
Professional skills	Time management, ethics, reliability, problem-solving and workplace behaviour

5. How a Recruitment Platform Could Solve the Problem

- MSME creates a structured job profile with required Ayurveda and supporting skills.
- Students create skill-based profiles instead of relying only on degree information.
- Students can show verified projects, internships, practical exposure and assessments.
- The system compares job requirements with candidate skills.
- It identifies missing skills rather than rejecting a candidate only because of limited experience.
- Short micro-courses can be recommended for clearly defined skill gaps.
- MSMEs receive a shortlist based on role fit, skills and evidence.

6. Example

MSME role: Ayurveda wellness-centre trainee/assistant

Possible requirements: Ayurveda fundamentals, patient communication, documentation, basic digital skills, supervised practical exposure.

Candidate Skill	Status
Ayurveda fundamentals	Strong
Patient communication	Needs assessment
Documentation	Needs improvement

Digital skills	Basic
Practical exposure	Internship evidence available

The system could identify documentation and communication as areas requiring additional evidence or training. A short micro-course could then address the specific gap before or during the hiring process.

7. Research-Based Context

NCISM maintains formal undergraduate Ayurveda curriculum and internship-related resources, and its standards describe attached teaching hospitals as environments for clinical training, consultation, diagnosis, treatment, counselling, documentation and hospital-management activities. This supports the importance of practical and workplace-oriented capabilities alongside academic knowledge. ■cite■turn0search36■turn0search2■

The current NCISM ecosystem also includes recognised Ayurveda colleges and continuing updates to education and institutional standards, indicating that the Ayurveda education and professional ecosystem is actively evolving. ■cite■turn0search0■turn0search1■

Official AYUSH-sector recruitment notices also show a range of teaching, medical, research and other roles, illustrating that Ayurveda-related career pathways extend beyond a single type of clinical position. ■cite■turn0search12■

8. Key Findings

- Recruitment should be based on role-specific skills, not only on BAMS/qualification status.
- Practical exposure and the ability to demonstrate skills are important for employer confidence.
- Communication, documentation and professional skills can be important alongside Ayurveda knowledge.
- Different Ayurveda MSMEs require different combinations of clinical, research, product, digital and business-support skills.
- Small organisations may benefit from structured job descriptions and simple skill-assessment tools.
- The most promising project opportunity is to connect MSME job requirements, Ayurveda-student skills, assessment and targeted micro-learning.

9. Final Problem Statement

“Ayurveda-focused MSMEs often face difficulty identifying and recruiting students or fresh graduates who possess the specific combination of Ayurveda knowledge, practical exposure and workplace skills required for a particular role.”

A solution can therefore focus on **skill-based matching + practical skill verification + skill-gap identification + micro-course recommendations**.

10. Primary Research Sources

- National Commission for Indian System of Medicine (NCISM) — Minimum Essential Standards, Assessment and Rating for Undergraduate Ayurveda Colleges and Attached Teaching Hospitals, 2023/updated framework. ■cite■turn0search36■
- NCISM — official regulations and Ayurveda education/curriculum resources. ■cite■turn0search0■turn0search2■
- NCISM — official information on Ayurveda institutions and current regulatory/education updates. ■cite■turn0search1■turn0search11■
- National Institute of Homoeopathy / Ministry of AYUSH recruitment portal — examples of current AYUSH-sector recruitment activity, including Ayurveda-related posts. ■cite■turn0search12■

Research note: This report is a project-oriented synthesis. The recruitment challenges are framed from official Ayurveda education requirements and the practical needs of small employers; where a specific challenge is presented as a project hypothesis rather than a nationally quantified statistic, it should be validated through primary interviews/surveys with Ayurveda MSMEs and students.